

12.2 Workshop:

Night Vision in Three Easy Steps

In this workshop, we'll take a drab old picture of a doorway, and make it look like something you might see if you were wearing a pair of night vision goggles. To get the most convincing effect from this technique, you should pick a picture of a setting that one would normally use night vision in—dark corridors, outdoor night-time photographs and the like.



The door (before)

Stage I: The Blinding Light

Night vision basically squeezes light out of dark scenes to help you see as much as possible, and so when you look at an otherwise dull bulb through night vision goggles, it's going to look like a blinding beacon.

By that reasoning, the first order of business is to kick up the highlights in the image to make the bright spots *really* bright.

Go to Image > Adjustments > Levels, or press [Ctrl] + [L] to get to the Levels dialog box. Drag the slider on the right towards the left to bring it closer to the most dense part of the histogram; you will see the highlights getting exaggerated as you do this. To avoid losing details in so much light, also drag the slider on the right towards